



WEBINAR SERIES #2: Impact of COVID-19 on Post Earthquake Recovery and Reconstruction in Nepal and the way forward.

[*Click here to check the recorded webinar.*](#)

HIGHLIGHTS

- [NRA decides on the top up support of NPR 50,000 for vulnerable households](#)
- [A Webinar on the Impact of COVID-19 on post-earthquake recovery and reconstruction](#)
- [COVID-19 Pandemic: Live Updates & Nepal Humanitarian Response Update](#)

- **Urban Recovery Strategy Workshop, May 21 2020**
- **Preliminary findings from the Cost of construction analysis report, May 2020**
- **Housing construction trend analysis from housing typology collection**

FEATURED TECHNICAL STAFF STORY: Rewat Dangi, Assistant Sub-Engineer



Rewat Dangi
*Assistant Sub-Engineer
Bagmati Rural Municipality,
Lalitpur*

Rewat Dangi, has been working as an Assistant Sub-Engineer for the last four years in Asrang, Ward 6, Bagmati Rural Municipality, Lalitpur. He is still in his duty station working even during the COVID-19 lockdown. He was not able to travel back to his hometown in Jhapa district before the lockdown was put in place. But he has no regrets as he is busy supporting the reconstruction of some beneficiaries who are continuing the work with the help of local masons in Asrang.

He says, if it were not for this situation of lockdown, the reconstruction in Asrang would have been completed by June 2020 (Asadh 2077). He hopes that as and when the lockdown is eased or lifted, all the concerned stakeholders will provide continuity to the reconstruction works following precautionary measures and maintaining social distancing, in order to complete the reconstruction process on time.

Tashi Tharpali Gumba Retrofitting, Roshi Rural Municipality, Kavrepalanchok: Tashi



Tharpali Gumba (Monastery) undergoing retrofitting during the COVID-19 pandemic lockdown. The retrofitting work is carried out under the local Community Member Committee of ward 11, Roshi Rural Municipality. The retrofitting materials were purchased before the nationwide lockdown. GMaLI provided 300,000 NPRs for retrofitting of the Gumba where jacketing technique has been used with involvement of six masons.

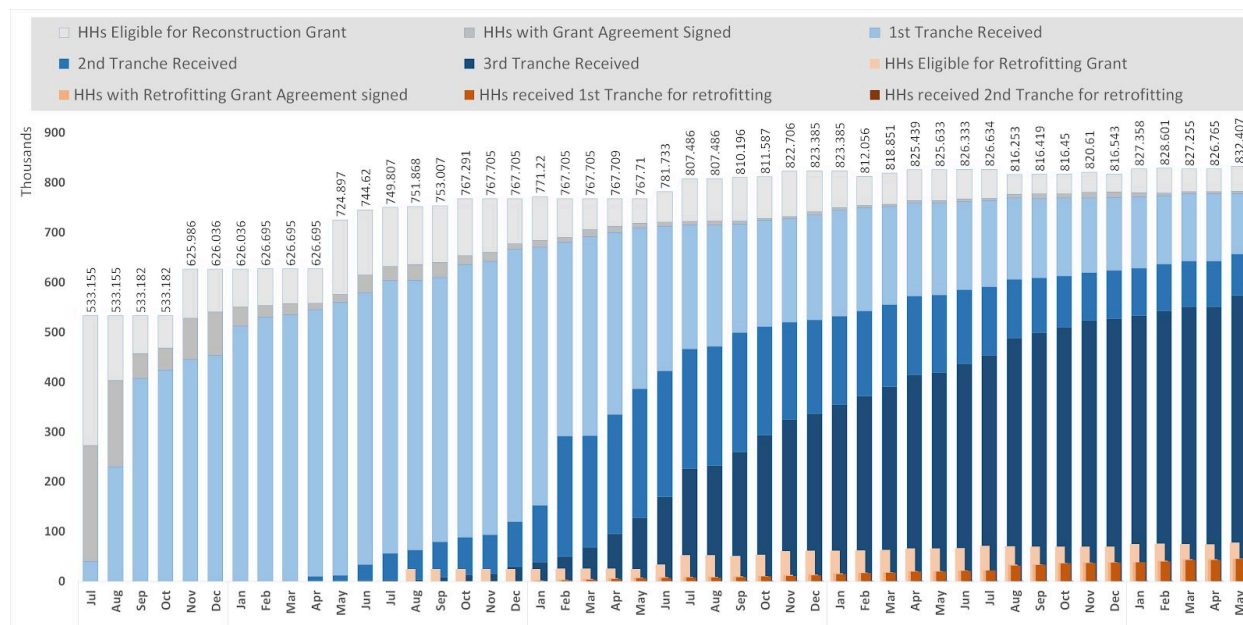


Masons applying jacketing around the exterior wall of Gumba

NATIONAL UPDATES

[NRA, CLPIU GMaLI and Building. Grant Disbursement Data, as of 25 May 2020:](#)

Reconstruction Grant	30 March	23 April	25 May
Total No. Eligible HHs	827255	826765	832407
HHs Enrolled	781176	781176	782359
HHs Received 1st Tranche	776953	776957	778032
HHs Applied for 2nd Tranche	648889	648889	648889
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	641994	642026	656066
Non-complaint at 2nd Tranche	2812	2812	2812
HHs Applied for 3rd Tranche	565075	565076	565076
HHs Received 3rd Tranche	550532	550590	573118
Non-complaint at 3rd Tranche	2214	2214	2214
Houses Completed	494044	494044	494044
HHs with Completion Certificate	83019	83019	83019
Retrofit Grant	30 March	23 April	25 May
Total No. Eligible HHs	74745	74168	78028
HHs Enrolled	44115	44115	45639
HHs Received 1st Tranche	42854	42854	45262
HHs Received 2nd Tranche	81	81	133



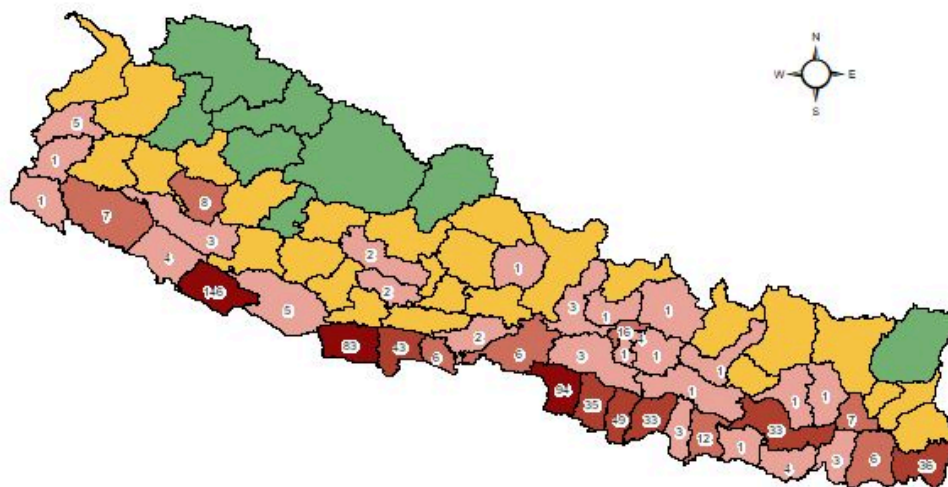
Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA, GMAI CLPIU data as of 25 May 2020.

A Webinar on the Impact of COVID-19 on post-earthquake recovery and reconstruction:

On 14 May 2020, NRA and HRRP jointly organized a Webinar Session including reconstruction stakeholders, with the objective of sharing preliminary findings of the survey¹ carried out by HRRP along with the panel discussion, to find an appropriate strategy for housing reconstruction in the prevailing COVID-19 context. The survey's preliminary findings revealed that availability of masons, laborers, construction materials, and mobility constraints were the greatest challenges of housing reconstruction. The four panelists consisted of NRA (Dr. Chandra), DFID-Nepal (Ms. Amada Duff), NSET (Mr. Surya Narayan Shrestha) and BBC Media Action (Ms. Sobhana Pradhan), who highlighted on some of the pertinent issues of the reconstruction workforce, their resumption to reconstruction business following standard operating procedure (SOP) guidelines to prevent them and the community from COVID-19 spread, including health safety for all after lifting of the lockdown. The CEO stated that the mobilization of the field staff is not

¹ The study was aimed at understanding how the post-earthquake recovery and reconstruction works are being affected by COVID-19 across 32 earthquake-affected districts. The study included a wide range of stakeholders from all 32 earthquake-affected districts including partner organizations, CLPIUs, donors, engineers, mobile masons, social mobilizers including direct earthquake beneficiaries. Total 745 respondents participated out of targeted 748 respondents.

relevant during the lockdown; it can be possible on a village-level, but it is not possible on a larger scale. Total 129 participants participated in the webinar session. The Webinar recording can be accessed [here](#) and notes from the session can be read [here](#).



NRA decides on the top up support of NPR 50,000 for vulnerable households: The NRA Executive Committee Meeting held on 8 May 2020, decided to provide top-up support of NPR 50,000 to vulnerable households who have not been able to reconstruct their houses. The beneficiaries should be enlisted in the DLPIU-GMaLI vulnerable list and must not have taken support from partner organizations. They should be endorsed by the Ward Chairpersons followed by Rural Municipality Chairperson or Municipality Mayor with the final approval from the District Reconstruction Facilitation Committee to be eligible for the top-up support.

Sighadurbar retrofitting work gains momentum: Retrofitting work of the main building of Singha Durbar has reportedly gained momentum taking into consideration the workforce's health safety and security measures. The consulting company has managed accommodation and food for all the workforce within the premises of Singha Durbar, including daily temperature check up and physical distancing to continue with the retrofitting work.

Urban Recovery Strategy Workshop, May 21 2020: HRRP hosted an urban recovery strategy workshop online, all day through Thursday, 21 May, in order to collectively brainstorm on urban housing recovery issues and recommendations. The workshop was held on Zoom with 6 breakout rooms for working sessions on Land, Heritage, Finance and Urban Vulnerability Urban STA and Communication, Policy and NRA Processes and Retrofitting.

The workshop kicked off with understanding the current status and challenges in urban reconstruction and retrofitting. While 25% of rural recovery caseload remains, about 43% of urban recovery caseload is still pending. Further, outside of Kathmandu Valley, 65% beneficiaries have accessed the third tranche, while within the valley only 33% have accessed the third tranche. This indicates that many cases are stuck due to various issues within the valley.

Each team worked on the status quo, stakeholder mapping and issues, and then proposed recommendations which may later be developed to “strategies”. The recommendations were categorized as short-term and long-term from the perspective of roles and responsibilities of different stakeholders in urban recovery. The work done by HRRP teams will be carried forward to develop a comprehensive Urban Recovery Strategy, addressing the cross-cutting nature of urban reconstruction and retrofitting. For More information, contact Sneha Malani, Urban Recovery Advisor: sneha@hrrpnepal.org

COVID-19 Pandemic: Live Updates & Nepal Humanitarian Response Update

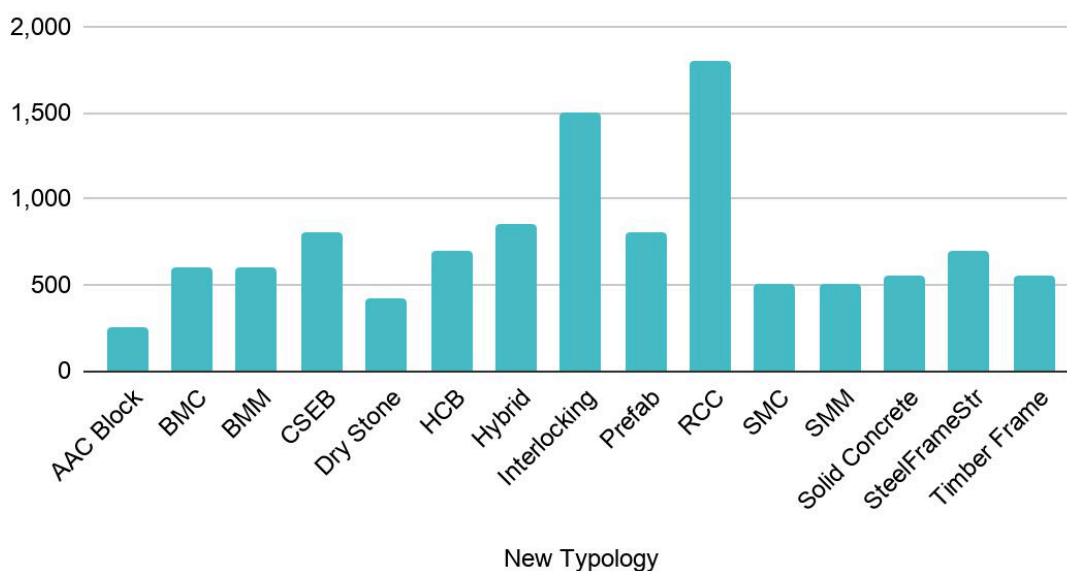
With the lockdown further extended until 2nd June, reconstruction has been greatly impacted. Total 603 positive Coronavirus cases have been detected, (3 deaths, 87 recovered and 513 undergoing medical treatment in isolation) as of 25 May.

Cost of Construction: The analysis of Cost of Construction is based on different data sources viz; Housing Typology information collected by HRRP District Teams either during field visits or collected from Government and Partner Organizations from April 2019 to April 2020 and from the COVID-19 Impact Survey conducted from 1 - 10 May 2020. In total 932 respondents from 32 earthquake affected districts are included in the analysis.

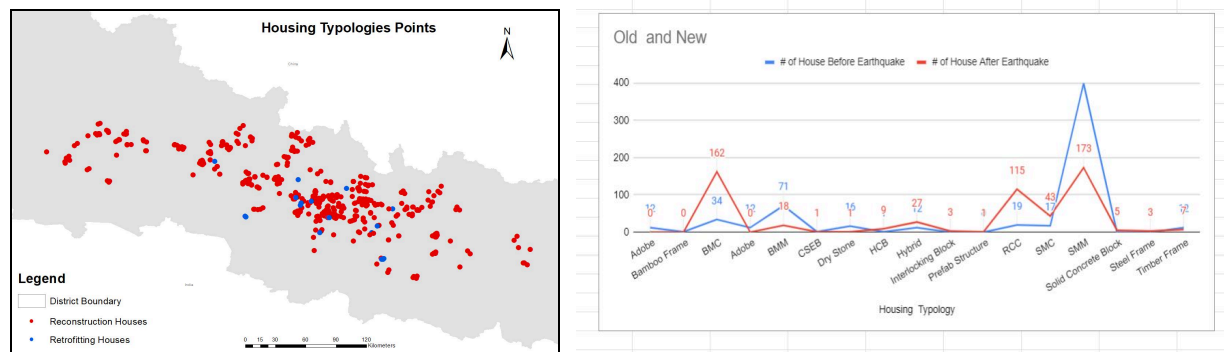
Some key information included in the analysis are: (1) Cost of Construction / Estimated cost, (2) Cost of construction by housing types, (3) Loans taken, interest rate and the types of financial institution loans taken from and (4) Cost of Retrofitting.

- The median cost to build a house is 650,000 NPRs.
- Costs range from 25,000 NPRs, a Hollow Concrete Block house at plinth level to 10,000,000 NPRs for construction of RCC houses in Kathmandu and Lamjung.
- The median cost of Stone and Mud Mortar Masonry (SMM) houses is 500,000 NPRs.
- The median cost of retrofitting a house is 350,000 NPRs.
- The average annual interest rate is 20.45% ranging from 0% that is interest free loans to 36% both from friends/relatives/neighbours

Median cost of construction (Thousands) of Typology

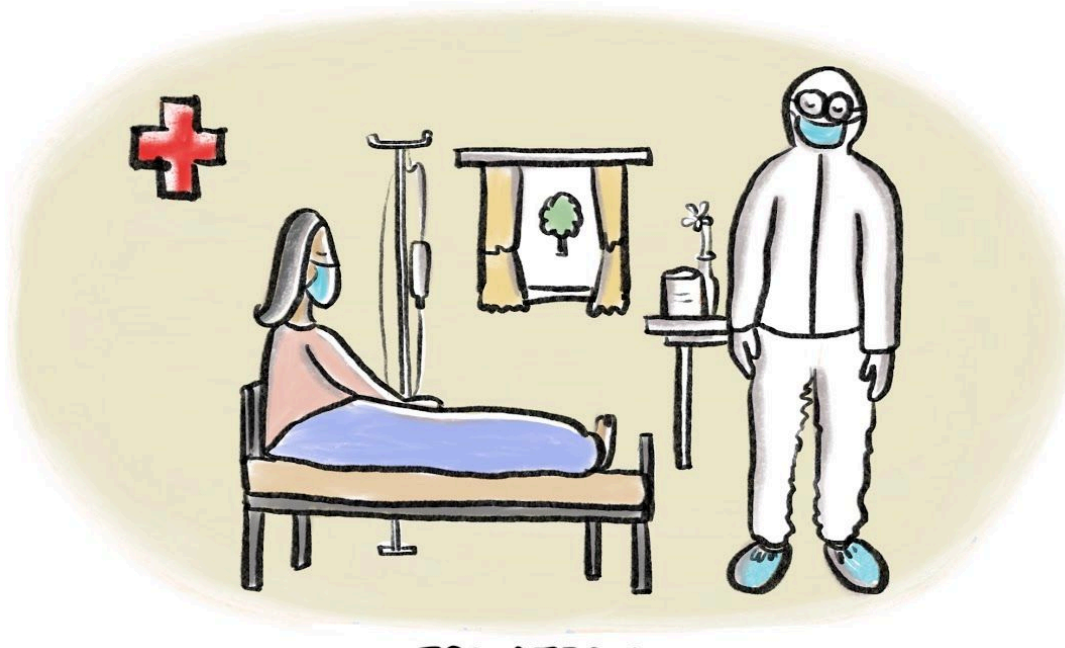


Housing Typology: A total of 597 housing typologies have been collected by HRRP District Coordination Teams from 28 out of 32 earthquake affected districts either directly during field visits or sourced from Government and Partner Organizations staff from April 2019 to April 2020.



A shift has been seen in the housing types post 2015 earthquake in Nepal. A major change has been from load bearing Stone and Mud Mortar Masonry (SMM) structures to other housing types. SMM which was predominantly present before the 2015 earthquake has now been replaced mostly with load bearing Brick and Cement Mortar Masonry (BMC) structures. While two-storied and four-roomed houses were more common before the earthquake, in the post earthquake, most houses built are single storey with two rooms.

Difference between Isolation and Quarantine for Covid19



Isolation separates Covid19 positive patients from people who are not sick



Quarantine separates and restricts the movement of people who were exposed to Covid19 positive

patients, typically for 14 days, in order to avoid the spread of infection in case the quarantined person has contracted the disease.

DISTRICT & MUNICIPAL UPDATES

In **Kavrepalanchok**, GMaLI office reported that the office deposited 139 cheques to the banks for further clearance and disbursement to the beneficiaries. GMaLI also noted that around **800 beneficiaries** received Government housing grants during the COVID-19 lockdown period. GMaLI has been following up with local vendors and contractors of the bridge construction and has conducted a monitoring visit taking into account precaution and safety measures. Further, **retrofitting of Gumba and Stupa** has been ongoing and masons are in communication with technical staff for any technical support required.

In **Kathmandu**, DLPIUs GMaLI and Building noted that they have been working on a backlog of tranche status and CS Entry as the reconstruction activities have been affected due to the lockdown, and at the same time they are planning on the working modality during the lockdown period.

In **Bhaktapur** and **Lalitpur**, GMaLI noted that the tranche distribution activities have been halted though few technical staff in some wards are continuing the reconstruction works. The MIS focal points also noted that they have been doing MIS compliance works using web-based technologies. GMaLI Lalitpur shared that the decision has been made on **land purchase of some families** who have to be relocated in Bagmati Rural Municipality. However, due to the closure of banks, the distribution of relocation grants has not been done yet. Further, Lalitpur GMaLI is focussing on the preparation of **cheques for releasing grants** to the beneficiaries whose houses have been inspected and verified by DLPIU Building. GMaLI is also following up with banks on the tranche disbursement to the beneficiaries, and at the same time to do the online reporting on the MIS.

In **Dolakha**, DLPIU Building has requested the technical staff to prioritize on the digitization of inspection files and cross check on the ones with missing information such as photos remaining to be uploaded to the system and also digitization pending for some inspection. The priority should be on the basis of **(1) all the inspection files that have been digitized but no photos have been uploaded in the third inspection, (2) Third inspection digitized but first and second have not been digitized, and to focus on second should be prioritized over the first one, (3) first and second inspection digitized but not third one**. Finally, DLPIU Building has requested the field technical staff including the social mobilizers and mobile masons to focus on data and photos collection for priorities 1 and 3 while the technical staff not in field should focus on priority 2 listed above.

In **Lamjung**, GMaLI reported that reconstruction grants were deposited in few of the beneficiaries' accounts mainly of those eligible for second and third tranches, including **501 for second tranche and 11 Households for third tranche**. First tranche to **123 new** households were also deposited in the bank. These payments were made of those houses inspected before the lockdown. GMaLI office also reported that **due to insufficient grant amount available at district, there has been delay in processing of the files causing impact on the tranche disbursement**. Some amounts received during the lockdown were distributed in cash to the beneficiaries, but still a lot is remaining for distribution. GMaLI office has now planned to prioritize the grant distribution, such that initially payments will be made to the households eligible for the second tranche, and then only to the households eligible for the third tranche.

HRRP District Coordination Team Bhaktapur, Lalitpur Monthly Report, 24 Apr - 22 May 2020



Ward No 9, Madhyapur Thimi Municipality, Bhaktapur: 2.5 storey, 10 roomed, RCC structure. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dolakha, Ramechhap, Sindhuli Monthly Report, 24 Apr - 22 May 2020



Ward 1, Likhu Tamakoshi Rural Municipality, Ramechhap: Single storey, stone and mud mortar structure with timber bands. The house has an attic which was corrected using vertical timber bars between lintel and roof bands as per the guidance from the District Support Engineer. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Dhading, Gorkha Monthly Report, 24 Apr – 22 May 2020



Ward 12, Nilkantha Municipality, Dhading: Single storey, two-roomed, Brick and Cement Mortar Masonry house. The homeowner has received the first tranche of Government housing grant. The house is constructed in partial support by Kaadorie (KAAA). The total cost of construction was 600,000 NPRs. The homeowner will not get the remaining tranches from the Government as support is being received by KAAA.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu Monthly Report, 24 Apr – 22 May 2020



Ward 8, Nagarjun Municipality, Kathmandu: Single storey, two roomed, load bearing brick in cement mortar structure with CGI roof. The homeowner has received all three tranches of the Government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok Monthly Report, 24 Apr – 22 May 2020



Ward 3, Bhumlu Rural Municipality, Kavrepalanchok: Single storey, Stone and Mud Mortar Masonry (SMM) with adjoining toilet. The homeowner has received the second tranche and applied for the third tranche of the Government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Nuwakot, Rasuwa Monthly Report, 24 Apr – 22 May 2020



Ward 4, Suryagadhi Rural Municipality, Nuwakot: Single story, Stone and Mud Mortar Masonry with an attic. The homeowner has received all three tranches of Government housing grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team and Lamjung Cluster Monthly Report, 24 Apr – 22 May 2020



Ward 3, Phalebash Municipality, Parbat: Single storey, four-roomed, RCC frame structure with stone as infilled material. The homeowner has received the third tranche of Government housing grant.

FEATURED STORY



Featured Technical Staff, Rewat Dangi, is not only supporting the reconstruction but also lending his hands during this difficult time to the Ward Office in providing relief support to the people in need in the Ward.

He says he has been particularly supporting those households whose reconstruction works were under way before the lockdown was imposed. Additionally, he is also supporting those households who have only taken the first tranche, in the preparation of documents

to claim subsequent tranches.

"I have been sending files to the Building Office for approval of the tranche whenever I find vehicles coming to the Ward with travel permits" said Mr. Dangi. Altogether, 3 households have been recommended for the second tranche and 7 households for the third tranche. In addition, under his leadership, final inspection of 6 houses has been completed, adds Mr. Dangi. He also noted that 26 beneficiaries were provided with housing reconstruction completion certificates during this time in Asrang.

Rewat Dangi shares that people in Asrang were working hard to complete the reconstruction within the NRA set deadline. But now with restriction in transportation, people have not been able to purchase construction materials. The local traders in Asrang do not have sufficient either, the only nearest market is Chapagaun for which the people have to wait till the lockdown is lifted.

He confidently claims that if it were not for this situation of lockdown, the reconstruction in Asrang would have been completed by June 2020 (Asadh 2077). He hopes that as and when the lockdown is eased or lifted, all the concerned stakeholders will provide continuity to the reconstruction works, follow precautionary measures and maintain social distancing to complete the reconstruction process on time.

Vulnerable Households Reconstruction amidst COVID-19 Lockdown

Laxmi Maya Shrestha, Ward No.3, Likhu Rural Municipality, Okhaldhunga: Amid the COVID-19 lockdown, few people were seen busy digging out soil to start the reconstruction of two-roomed house in Narmadehswor, Likhu Rural Municipality, Okhaldhunga. The house belongs to Mrs. Laxmi Maya Shrestha, a 73-year-old single woman enlisted as a reconstruction beneficiary under the vulnerable category of National Reconstruction Authority (NRA).

After the 2015 earthquake damaged her house, Laxmi has been moving around with her disabled daughter, sometimes living with her other three daughters who are married and at times at neighbors' house and her damaged house itself.

Laxmi has received the first tranche and had planned to start reconstruction, and to have it completed before the monsoon hits the country. But she has been stuck at her daughter's house in Kathmandu due to the COVID-19 lockdown and was much worried about the reconstruction of her house in the village.

Thanks to Laxmi's relatives who coordinated with the Ward Office in her absence, the reconstruction is moving forward amidst the lockdown. The Ward Office decided to deploy mobile masons for the reconstruction of her house under the supervision of the field technical staff and support from social mobilizers. Additionally, her relatives contributed as laborers. As noted, the salvaged materials from her old damaged house will be utilized for the reconstruction on top of the grant provided by the Government.



Laxmi Shrestha's house: process of digging the soil to start reconstruction, where her relatives are contributing as laborers for the reconstruction.

Kuma Maharjan, Ward No.6, Dakshinkali Municipality, Kathmandu: Mr. Kuma Maharjan's wish to live in a new house is finally coming true. A senior citizen, Mr Kuma with his brother has been living in a temporary shelter since the 2015 earthquake damaged his house. Mr. Kuma had received the first tranche of the Government housing grant but due to a weak economic condition, he could not even demolish his old damaged house.

Almost a year ago, Kuma's house was dismantled as per approved sub-project of the DLPIU GMaLI as part of Environment and Social Management plan under Environment and Social Management Framework on dismantling damaged houses and management of debris about 300m away (site recommended by the Ward Office). In addition, Ward Office also took responsibility for constructing a two-roomed load bearing brick and cement mortar masonry structure within the 300,000 NPRs grant provided by the Government for housing reconstruction. Even after the demolition of the old house, the reconstruction had not started. Now, with completion of all necessary municipal procedures including the building permit, the construction of Mr. Kuma's house began amidst the COVID-19 lockdown.



Kuma Maharjan's temporary shelter and his new house under construction in front of his temporary shelter.

Under the technical supervision of the focal engineer, the team of eight mobile masons and two social mobilizers deployed by the NRA began the reconstruction work and have so far completed the foundation. The team plans to complete and hand over the house to Mr. Kuma before the rainy season.

Padam Kumari Magar, Ward No. 4, Manthali Municipality, Ramechhap: A 79-year-old, single woman, has started reconstruction of her house during the COVID-19 pandemic lockdown in the country. She has been living with her daughter and son-in-law since the 2015 earthquake. She had received her first tranche but with no other source of income and inability to manage construction, she had not been able to start reconstruction. But now, with the help of her son-in-law, she has procured construction materials and in coordination with the Ward Office, the reconstruction has begun.

Eleven mobile masons and three social mobilizers are involved in the construction of Padam's house as part of On-the-Job Training as directed by DLPIU Building Ramechhap. Although the masons are following the social distance protocol while working, it's not the same as working during the pre-lockdown period, said the masons. At times, for some work like concreting, maintaining social distance is difficult and working in shifts is also not practical with masons having different expertise. Further, there is no protective equipment and standard operating guidelines to guide them on their work.

It has become difficult, in terms of commuting, some masons have to walk a whole day to reach the construction site, and also some masons were not allowed to walk and get to the site by the security at the checkpoints. Somehow, the son-in-law of Padam has now managed accommodation for the masons who have to travel from far away.

There are no COVID-19 cases reported in Ramechhap so far but without proper protective equipment and safety measures, amidst the fear of COVID-19, masons and technical staff

are determined to complete the reconstruction of Padam's house on time before the monsoon.



Padam Kumari in front of her house undergoing reconstruction. Masons working maintaining social distancing during COVID-19 lockdown.

MEDIA COVERAGE & COMMUNICATION ON RECONSTRUCTION



[Baliyo Ghar Surakshit Nepal-Part 17 | 24 May 2020](#): This episode discusses the role of Partner Organizations in the reconstruction of vulnerable households. Partner Organizations (POs) have exclusively discussed their approach and kind of support that they have provided to vulnerable households and also discussed the COVID-19 challenges facing these vulnerable households. This program was aired on Kantipur Television on 24 May 2020 at 6:30 & 10:00 PM.

NATIONAL PRODUCTS

[Monthly e-newsletter of National Reconstruction Authority April 2020](#)

HRRP PRODUCTS



[Palika Profiles \(Municipal reconstruction profiles\)](#)

The recovery profiles contain various updates on the reconstruction and recovery at the Municipal level for all 282 earthquake-affected municipalities. The municipalities are updating the profiles on a monthly basis with technical support from HRRP.



[Reconstruction and Retrofitting Information Pack](#)

This highlights the reconstruction and retrofitting progress in all 32-earthquake affected districts at the municipal level. This data is updated by HRRP district staff in close coordination with municipal focal persons. The links will be automatically updated to provide the reconstruction snapshot (PDF) for the month.



[Municipal dataset on Reconstruction](#)

[CSV, PDF](#)

A composite dataset for 282 municipalities (urban status, damage grade, reconstruction, retrofitting and vulnerable HHs as identified by NRA can be assessed here as CSV and PDF). The dataset is updated by the municipalities with support from HRRP.

PARTNER PRODUCTS

[BBC Media Action -Transforming lives through media around the world:](#) Through the Covid-19 response, BBC Media Action's dedicated teams are engaging in providing life-saving information to vulnerable communities, and supporting local/national partners across the globe. This is being undertaken through the use of new and innovative distance research methods, ensuring the health and safety of the production teams. They are also engaging in addressing the longer-term impacts of Covid-19. For example: through their women's empowerment project in Afghanistan tackling increased gender-based violence in these times. Please read details and highlights from their Covid-19 response [here](#).

At the webinar on Covid-19's impacts on reconstruction that was recently hosted by HRRP, Ms. Shobhana Pradhan; the Country Director of BBC Media Action in Nepal, shared her views on the media's role in Covid-19 response. She shared the challenges around effective media response, and highlighted the major mistakes made, viz. Skimping research, creating snazzy products without a real strategy, and avoiding conversations or dialogue with the communities. Please read further details in the [Webinar Report](#).

Helpline Services: Considering the psychosocial impact of the recent COVID-19, Transcultural Psychosocial Organization (TPO) Nepal has extended its helpline services to

everyone who is in need. They provide both psychosocial and mental health services. Individuals and partners are encouraged to use this service from 8:00 AM to 6:00 PM everyday. TPO Nepal **HELPLINE Toll Free Number: 1660 01 0 2005** (call to this number is free of cost from NTC network).

[FAQs](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [5W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)



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